

Day 09 – Microsoft Entra ID Administrative Units

Objective

Create an Administrative Unit (AU), add users, and understand how Administrative Units enable delegated administration.

What You'll Learn

- Administrative Units (AUs)
- Delegated Administration
- Scoped Role Assignments
- Least Privilege Access
- Identity Administration

What is an Administrative Unit?

An **Administrative Unit (AU)** lets you group users, groups, or devices so that administrators can manage **only those objects**, instead of the entire Microsoft Entra tenant.

Example:

- HR Admin manages only HR users.
- IT Admin manages only IT users.
- Europe Admin manages only Europe users.

Step 1 – Open Administrative Units

Go to:

Identity



Administrative units

or search for:

Administrative units

Step 2 – Create a New Administrative Unit

Click:

+ Add

Configure:

Field	Value
Name	IAM-Lab-AU
Description	Administrative Unit for IAM Lab

Click **Create**.

Screenshot 1

- Administrative Unit Overview

Add administrative unit ...

 Got feedback?

- Properties
- Assign roles
- Review + create**

Properties

Name	IAM-Lab-AU
Description	Administrative Unit for IAM Lab

Assignments

Create

Previous

Administrative units ...

Search administrative units		 Add filters	
Name	 Description	Restricted management	Membership type
☐ IAM-Lab-AU	Administrative Unit for IAM Lab	No	Assigned

Step 3 – Open the Administrative Unit

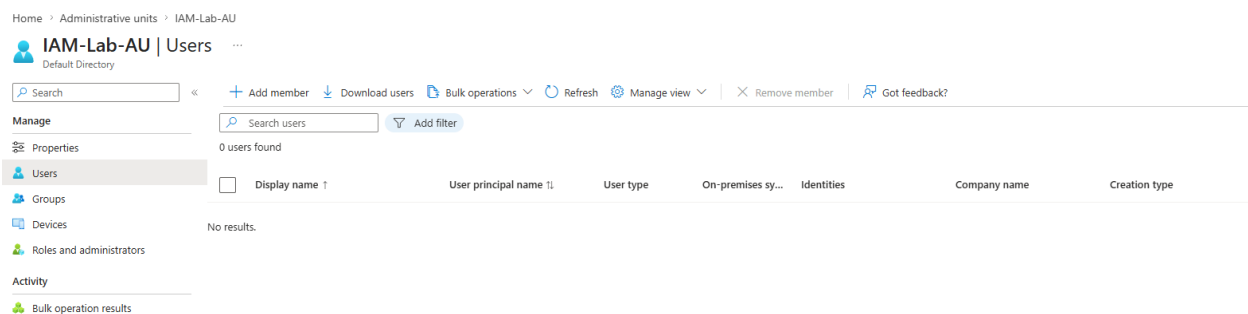
Open:

IAM-Lab-AU

You should see sections such as:

- Overview
- Users
- Groups
- Devices
- Administrative Roles

Screenshot 2



Step 4 – Add a User

Click:

Users

Then:

+ Add users

Select:

Alex Brown

Click:

Select

Screenshot 3

Home > Administrative units > IAM-Lab-AU

IAM-Lab-AU | Users ...

Default Directory

Search « + Add member Download users Bulk operations Refresh Manage view Remove member Got feedback?

Manage

Search users Add filter

1 user found

☐	Display name ↑	User principal name ↑	User type	On-premises sy...	Identities	Company name	Creation type
☐	 Alex Brown	alex.brown@farha...	Member	No	farhanmuntasiroutlook.onmicro		

Users

Properties

Groups

Devices

Roles and administrators

Activity

Bulk operation results

Step 5 – Review Administrative Roles

Click:

Administrative roles

Review the roles that can be assigned within the Administrative Unit.

Examples include:

- User Administrator
- Groups Administrator
- Authentication Administrator

You don't need to assign a role for this lab.

Screenshot 4

Home > Administrative units > IAM-Lab-AU

IAM-Lab-AU | Roles and administrators

Default Directory

Search

Manage

Properties

Users

Groups

Devices

Roles and administrators

Activity

Bulk operation results

Refresh

Preview features

Got feedback?

To create custom roles, your organization needs Microsoft Entra ID Premium P1 or P2. Start a free trial. →

Administrative roles

Administrative roles are used for granting access for privileged actions in Microsoft Entra ID. We recommend using these built-in roles for delegating access to manage broad application configuration permissions without granting access to manage other parts of Microsoft Entra ID not related to application configuration. [Learn more.](#)

[Learn more about Microsoft Entra ID role-based access control](#)

Search by name or description

Add filters

Role	Description	Privileged	Ass...	Type
Attribute Assignment Administrator	Assign custom security attribute keys and values to supported Microsoft Entra objects.		0	Built-in
Attribute Assignment Reader	Read custom security attribute keys and values for supported Microsoft Entra objects.		0	Built-in
Authentication Administrator	Can access to view, set and reset authentication method information for any non-admin user.	PRIVILEGED	0	Built-in
Cloud Device Administrator	Limited access to manage devices in Microsoft Entra ID.	PRIVILEGED	0	Built-in
Entra SOC Identity Responder	Perform identity containment actions for SOC incident response, including disabling users, revoking sessions, and resetting passwords.	PRIVILEGED	0	Built-in
Groups Administrator	Members of this role can create/manage groups, create/manage groups settings like naming and expiration policies, and view groups activity and audit reports.		0	Built-in
Helpdesk Administrator	Can reset passwords for non-administrators and Helpdesk Administrators.	PRIVILEGED	1	Built-in
Hybrid Identity Administrator	Can manage AD to Microsoft Entra cloud provisioning, Microsoft Entra Connect, and federation settings.	PRIVILEGED	0	Built-in
License Administrator	Can manage product licenses on users and groups.		0	Built-in
Lifecycle Workflows Administrator	Create and manage all aspects of workflows and tasks associated with Lifecycle Workflows in Microsoft Entra ID.	PRIVILEGED	0	Built-in
Password Administrator	Can reset passwords for non-administrators and Password Administrators.	PRIVILEGED	0	Built-in
Printer Administrator	Can manage all aspects of printers and printer connectors.		0	Built-in
Privileged Authentication Administrator	Can access to view, set and reset authentication method information for any user (admin or non-admin).	PRIVILEGED	1	Built-in
SharePoint Administrator	Can manage all aspects of the SharePoint service.		0	Built-in

Step 6 – Review Members

Go back to:

Users

Verify that **Alex Brown** is listed.

Screenshot 5

Home > Administrative units > IAM-Lab-AU

IAM-Lab-AU | Users

Default Directory

Search

Manage

Properties

Users

Groups

Devices

Roles and administrators

Activity

Bulk operation results

Add member

Download users

Bulk operations

Refresh

Manage view

Remove member

Got feedback?

Search users

Add filter

1 user found

	Display name ↑	User principal name ↑	User type	On-premises sy...	Identities	Company name	Creation type
☐	 Alex Brown	alex.brown@farha...	Member	No	farhamuntasiroutlook.onmicro		